

THE
COMMUNICATIONS
AND ELECTRONICS BRANCH

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
CFB KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4



BRANCHE
DES COMMUNICATIONS
ET DE L'ÉLECTRONIQUE

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BFC KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4

1000-5 (Br Adjt)

29 October 2020

Distribution List

2ND SENATE MEETING:
RECORD OF DECISIONS – THURSDAY, 29 OCTOBER 2020

RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

POSITION / APPOINTMENT	RANK & NAME
Chair	Brigadier-General (Retired) Kevin O'Keefe, Colonel-Commandant
Co-Chair	Brigadier-General James Lambert, Branch Leader
Member (Branch Leadership)	Colonel Eric Charron, Branch Advisor
Member (C&E Association)	Major-General (Retired) John Leech
Member (C&E Foundation)	Colonel (Retired) Steve Sibbald
Member (Serving GO)	Brigadier-General Patrice Sabourin
Member (Immediate Past Col Cmdt)	Brigadier-General (Retired) Bill Richard
Member (Home Station CO)	Lieutenant-Colonel Walter Gamblin
Guest (Director Signals)	Colonel Yannick Lemieux
Guest (Strategic A6)	Colonel Nick Torrington-Smith
Guest (Commander CFIOG)	Colonel Mark Parsons
Member (Affiliate Representative)	Major (Retired) Mike DeNoble
Member (Senior Branch Rep)	Lieutenant-General Frances Allen (UNAVAILABLE)
Member (Senior Reserve Rep)	Brigadier-General David Awalt (UNAVAILABLE)
Member (Honorary Colonel Rep)	Colonel Ken Lloyd (UNAVAILABLE)
Secretariat	Major Blair Christie, Branch Adjutant

RECORD OF DECISIONS

ITEM	DISCUSSION / DECISION ITEMS
01	AGENDA ITEM #1: INTRODUCTORY REMARKS <u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe and BGen Lambert – Introduction:</u> Chair welcomed all members to the meeting and outlined the agenda items. General O'Keefe extended a special thanks and acknowledgement to Director Signals, the Strategic A6, and Commander CFIOG. Action Item(s): Nil.
02	AGENDA ITEM #2: PREVIOUS RoD <u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – Approval of previous RoD:</u> No issues with prior RoD, save that some items have yet to be actioned and will be forwarded for execution. Action Item(s): Senate approved the 28 May 20 Senate Meeting RoD.

03	AGENDA ITEM #3: C&E FAMILY SENATE POLICY #1 <u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – Senate Policy Review and Approval:</u> ▪ Implement BP / Strat planning process document ▪ Expectation is clear, did not receive any major input except from BL and BA ▪ Assumption: ALCON comfortable with process and intent <u>MGen (Ret'd) Leech – Question:</u> Do we have a timeframe for implementation? (<i>O'Keefe Answer: 01 April 2021-22 is the goal for implementation of process</i>). Action Item(s): Nil
04	AGENDA ITEM #4: C&E FAMILY STRATEGIC GUIDANCE <u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – Overview:</u> Five-year plan (2021-2022 – 2026-2027) <u>BGen (Ret'd) Richard – Questions:</u> Page 3 – reference morale & welfare: people-side and sharing of roles between Branch and Association for support programs such as the <i>Distress Signal programme</i>. Where do retired members fit and how do they receive support? This needs to be defined and expressed in the Strat Guidance docs. (<i>O'Keefe Answer: Serving members = Branch OPI. Retired members = Association OPI. One key role of the Association is engagement and support of retired members</i>). Concurrence from MGen (Ret'd) Leech: more focus on retired member support required. Should be clearly articulated.

	<u>Additional Comments:</u> As follows ... ▪ MGen (Ret'd) Leech: ○ CMCEN requires lasting / enduring support (e.g. a dedicated staff officer to maintain it). ○ C&E Association: members must endeavour to increase PD programs, outreach initiatives, and generate funds (from sponsors, via attendance fees for PD events, etc.). ▪ Col (Ret'd) Sibbald: ○ The Senate decides actions and intents, but keep in mind limited serving members / volunteers / money. The Senate should also ID what we are <u>not</u> going to do given finite pers / material / fin resources and articulate / capture such details. Action Item(s): As follows ... ▪ BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe: Amend Strat Guidance with details confirming Association's supportive role to distressed retired members. ▪ MGen (Ret'd) Leech: Leverage Association for retired support / volunteerism as there are not enough personnel in uniform to support Branch-sanctioned initiatives.
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05	AGENDA ITEM #5: NETHERLANDS BATTLEFIELD TOUR <u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – Status Report:</u> BN outlines CURSIT. Difficult to carry-out 2021; maybe delayed until 2022 if feasible. Details on planned refund as follows: ▪ Prepared to return ALL MONEY to unit accounts for sponsored soldiers. This will cause a refund of \$44, 000.00 in estimation. ▪ A few units – rather than sending cheques, etc. directly to the Foundation – used Canada Helps. When this was done; charitable receipts were granted. Thus, the Branch <u>cannot</u> return the money IAW CRA legal policies. ▪ Several Reg / Res units did this including 1 x 36 Sig Regt soldier paid his own way. ▪ Any remaining funds after returning funds to units will remain in the Foundation account for future tour whenever this happens. ▪ Other expenses must be settled as well, such as \$10,000.00 loan from the Colonel Arthur J.E. Child Fund and \$1,000.00 in accoutrements (pins, flags, etc.) from the Mercury Kit Shop. <u>Additional Comments:</u> As follows ... ▪ BGen Sabourin: ○ Try to execute the BF Study tour as early as possible (e.g. NLT 2022). ○ Risk: Further delays result in postings & moves, hence a loss of corporate memory on the file. ▪ BGen (Ret'd) Richard: ○ Scale down the future tour to fit the budget. ▪ Col Parsons: ○ Decision Point is required ... look at the calendar, elect a timing when planning must occur, assess the CURSIT, make a decision, then decide what will happen to the money & BF Tour Plan. Recall that 1+ year lead-time required to develop programme / fund raising / liaison / tour guide / travel / logistics.
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	▪ Col Torrington-Smith: ○ There is a willingness to support the tour, but should we continue this at all? <i>(O’Keefe Answer: No money came from Foundation less \$5,000.00 for the Soldier of the Year ticket. Money came from donations, fund-raising, etc. IAW charitable tax receipts – we cannot give money back due to CRA policies: it must be used for this type of project. Taxation / legal impact if money is not used as what was intended).</i> Action Item(s): As follows ... ▪ BGen (Ret’d) O’Keefe Liaise with Foundation Treasurer to ensure amount of money and purpose is clearly tracked / identified. ▪ BGen (Ret’t) O’Keefe: Work with Branch and Foundation to ensure source of BF Study Tour money is clearly understood and articulated. There is a misunderstanding the money is coming from P070, etc. ▪ BGen (Ret’t) O’Keefe and Col Charron: Once decision is reached on future Battlefield Study work with Branch, Association, and Foundation to formulate a team to deliver successful Battlefield Study. ▪ Senate Decisions: ○ 1st – No Tour in 2021 ○ 2nd – Next Senate Meeting March 2021 is the Decision Point for future Battlefield Study in 2022 and formation of Study Planning Team. ○ 3rd – Refund to those units who raised funds and asked for their money back (only for those that (1) did <u>not</u> channel money through charitable agencies and (2) asked for it). Individual contact will happen with the Col Cmdt to each unit to confirm refund option or retain for future tour.
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06	AGENDA ITEM #6: COLONEL COMMANDANT / HONORARY COLONEL NOMINATIONS <u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – Status Report:</u> New Col Cmdt nomination is BGen (Ret'd) Josée Robidoux. File to be completed and submitted in the coming days. 77 Line Regiment adhered to C&E HCol Nomination guideline. File for Bhavana Varma received and endorsed for 77 LR HCol. Note that the application has an explicit endorsement block for the Branch Advisor and the Senate shall leverage this portion of the form to assert their endorsement on a file. Senate endorses both applications. Action Item(s): BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe: Amend HCol Nomination Process to ensure this Branch Advisor endorsement block is identified.
07	AGENDA ITEM #7: MUSEUM UPDATE <u>LCol Gamblin – Museum SITREP:</u> The museum shut down in March 2020 and has yet to re-open most services (save for Mercury Kit Shop). Looks like a really long time before it does re-open. This presents us with an opportunity: procure digital management tool to upload virtual collection. Access online. Distance from brick & mortar (B&M) delivery mechanism that predominately benefits only Kingston-based personnel. ▪ Senate Meeting: LCol Gamblin will forward BN to Co-chairs to explain how digital means can evolve and generate fund-raising initiatives with a blended B&M / virtual approach. Once agreed BN will be forwarded secretarially to Senate for approval. ▪ Concept: Those who pay via recorded means (P070, etc.) receive full access to museum / digital archives. Others will pay-for-access for online or B&M tour.

	<u>LCol Gamblin – Clarity on Accountabilities, Responsibilities, and Authorities:</u> Museum CO has accountability, responsibility, and authority (ARA) to the Branch Leader (or Advisor) and the Base Commander for Museum operations, supported by the Museum Manager. The Museum Manager’s ARA for Museum operations run through the Museum CO with HRM and financial accounting running to PSP (as PSP is providing a service to our Museum). The Museum Committee is responsible to the Museum Board of Directors for governance-related issues. <u>BGen Lambert – Standing Senate Entry:</u> This agenda item will remain as a standing entry to facilitate discussion / tracking. Action Item(s): As follows ... ▪ BGen (Ret’d) Keefe: Amend ToR page 4 to clearly state that the Branch Advisor serves as the Chair for the BoD (Board of Directors). ▪ Branch Advisor/CO Museum / Commandant CFSCE: Develop SLA between PSP and C&E C-of-C to clearly articulate roles and responsibilities between military and PSP. ▪ Branch Advisor/Commandant CFSCE: Proceed with CoA 2 (Reserve Officer Major as CO Museum). COA will ensure military presence in our Museum and will ultimately remove Commandant’s secondary role as CO Museum. COA will provide opportunity to re-assess results and adjust HR structure thereafter.
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08	AGENDA ITEM #8: C&E FOUNDATION UPDATE (FINANCES) <u>Col (Ret'd) Sibbald – Foundation SITREP:</u> Four (4) key items to highlight: ▪ 1 – BoD: 3 x applications received for AGM discussion / 3 retiring (9 total remains). 5-20 range of directors sought, so Foundation numbers are low. Misconception abounds concerning rank and help is needed to dispel it rank: the Foundation wants more people from across the rank spectrum. Col (Ret'd) Sibbald is retiring next year. Need to advertise Museum Chair. ▪ 2 – Membership: It is not a '<i>closed club</i>'; it is open up to all members: ▪ 3 – Finances: Endowment fund predominately came from bequests / donations, etc. It has grown by re-rolling interest money back into principal amount. Cannot touch the principal. Can spend the interest. Must now look at dipping into the Endowment Fund (to the tune of \$80K) ... the first time ever ... to pay for museum-related operating expenses (op costs, salaries, projects, etc.). The \$10,000 Digital Collect Mgt tool (mentioned above) will further cut into the draw of principal funding. Foundation wants Senate / Museum BoD to make decisions on how the money shall be spent, and the Foundation will act upon it. Senate needs to receive a balanced budget proposal from the museum or a plan to address any annual budget deficits. Branch Advisor commented that \$100K annual funds from Base to Museum are not in jeopardy. ▪ 4 – Fund-Raising: What activities look promising as fund-raisers? Previous events where hyper-targeted for very specific events. May wish to expand fund-raising to reflect generic Branch / Museum / Foundation support.
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	Action Items(s): As follows ... ▪ Branch Advisor/Cmdt CFSCE/CO Museum develop SLA between Museum and Base to confirm the annual transfer of funds between two organizations. ▪ BGen Lambert: Promote pay allotments. ▪ ALCON: Publish / Advertise C&E Foundation role and understanding to units ▪ Col Charron: Investigate / rejuvenate the Malloch Trophy ▪ Col Cmdt: Address items identified as Senate responsibility
09	AGENDA ITEM #9: C&E ASSOCIATION UPDATE <u>MGen (Ret'd) Leech – Association SITREP:</u> NSTR – Money is an ongoing issue. Action Items(s): Nil.
10	AGENDA ITEM #10: 2023 HRH VISIT <u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – Colonel-in-Chief Visit:</u> 175th anniversary of 8th Canadian Hussars in 2023. They asked other units (Signals / Medical / Grey and Simcoe Foresters/Royal Regina Rifles if they wish to use this occasion to visit their C-in-C. A co-ord committee will be established. <u>BGen Lambert – Lessons Learned from Celebration 2013:</u> Extremely busy, hectic, and time-consuming appointment to be the official Visits Officer. Let the 8th CH assume this role and we – as a Branch – can leverage it as guests. BPT to co-ord a planning committee linked in with 8th CH. Action Item(s): Nil (at this time) ... keep as recurring entry for Senate Meetings.

11	AGENDA ITEM #11: H&A UPDATE <u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe – Confirmation of Award Recipients:</u> H&A as follows ... ▪ C-in-C Commendation: Brigadier-General (Retired) Bob Martineau ▪ C-in-C Commendation: Master Warrant Officer Patrice Guevremont (33 Sig Regt) ▪ Subaltern of the Year: Captain Garrett McDonald (CFJSR) ▪ Member of the Year: Master Corporal Joshua Townsend (CFIOG – Det Alaska) ▪ Heritage Awards: 3 x awards bestowed ○ Lieutenant-Colonel (Retired) Mervyn Embury ○ Chief Warrant Officer (Retired) Maynard (Butch) Whitlaw ○ Chief Petty Officer 1st Class (Retired) Wayne Moore Action Item(s): Major Christie: Handle all financial/ logistical / administrative arrangements for the H&A (trophies, certificates, delivery options, etc.).
12	AGENDA ITEM #12: C&E WEEK 2020 UPDATE <u>Col Charron – C&E Week 2020 Overview:</u> NSTR – see Branch Update materials / recorded lecture. Action Item(s): ALCON: Provide AAR point / observations / lessons learned / feedback to Brach Adjutant for collection and staffing to Branch Leadership. Provide total involvement estimations as well (e.g. how many from CA, RCAF, and CFIOG – down to the unit / flight / OUTCAN Det level, etc. – were attending from a single feed)?

13	AGENDA ITEM #13: OPEN DISCUSSION AND ADJOURNMENT <u>BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe & BGen Lambert – Conclusion:</u> NSTR. Action Item(s): Nil.
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